created the consumer council in order to enable consumers to express themselves on issues reserved to producers and traders. Further it became a single European Act which was economic and social committee to safeguard the consumers.

In India, the ancient Vedas and various other ancient codes also contained provisions to protect the interests of the consumers and provided punishment in case of violations. During British rule in India, the rights and interest of consumers were mainly regulated and protected by the common law of Tort or Law of Contracts.

In India first formal consumer movement was started in 1949 in Madras (chennai). Later a consumer protection council was established in Madras under the patronage of Shri C. Rajagopalachari. The work of Council was confined only to the people of Tamil Nadu. In 1956, nine housewives and social workers combined together to form the Consumer Guidance Society of India (CGSI) in Bombay. The Consumer Guidance Society of India (CGSI) is a Non-Profit consumer organization CGSI was the first consumer organization to demand special Consumer Court for redressal of consumers' complaints. CGSI's constant follow-up was instrumental in enacting the Consumer Protection Act, 1986 (CPA) amended in 2000.

2.2 Consumer

A consumer is a person who buys goods and services and makes use of public utilities as well as natural resources like water. It refers to those who use goods and services for their personal wants and excludes buyers who purchase for manufacturing purposes or for resale.

It does not include a person who obtains such goods for sale or any commercial purpose.



2.3 Consumer Problems

Consumers face a wide range of problems in their day today dealings. These problems may be the result of scarcity, varying incomes, product development, environmental changes or social structure. The consumers face problems even in markets, banks, government and private offices, hospitals, schools, public distribution agencies and other services.



Problems faced by consumer can be categorized as:

i. Problems related to products.

ii. Problems related to services.

XII Std - Home Science EM_Unit 2.indd 52 23-03-2020 3.29.19 PM